

Not getting through

But not everyone agrees with giving foreign aid like this. There are some who argue, wrongly, that countries are poor because the people are lazy or corrupt, and they don't deserve to be helped. Others point out that often the money we give isn't being used in the right way. It isn't reaching the people who need it most, and isn't helping poor countries to develop and become prosperous. Even people within poor countries realize that money alone isn't enough to tackle the causes of poverty. Much of the money from charities, for example, is spent in providing things like food and clothing, or medicines and doctors, to people living in poverty. While this deals with their immediate needs, it doesn't provide for the future.

Foreign aid is sometimes given to the governments of poor countries, but does not reach the people who need it. This can be because they live in remote areas and do not have access to transportation, or because the government manages the money badly or uses it for its own projects rather than to help its citizens. Some poor countries have borrowed money from organizations such as the World Bank, but this hasn't been enough to establish a stable and growing economy, and they have ended up with the long-term burden of repaying that debt.

**THE NOTION THAT AID CAN
ALLEVIATE SYSTEMIC
POVERTY... IS A MYTH.**

DAMBISA MOYO